

Friendster

The trend of using computers for social networking actually started with the social networking web site called Friendster, which was launched in 2002 and continues to have millions of users

Twitter App for BlackBerry

The Twitter app for BlackBerry was launched in April this year. This app provides real-time push of Twitter messages, offers camera and photo gallery integration and much more

For students, by students and of students...

Billionaires in the making? We present two inspirational stories for Indian students...

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The fact that Larry Page and Sergey Brin had been students at Stanford when they conceived of Google has been chewed and regurgitated so many times that now it has started sounding like a monumental cliché. Then there is Mark Zuckerberg who gave birth to Facebook while he was still in college; Bill Gates and Michael Dell are also famous for having started very young. So can we then make the case that in order to make a mark in technology, you need to start young? The cycle of innovation in the tech industry does seem to favour the fast movers. Now, a few university students have come up with savvy business strategy of reaching out to smartphones users through two mobile apps – Fountainhop and Scoop.

Though these applications are yet to reach out to larger community of students, they have already created an

ample amount of buzz. Could this be the Next Big Thing of the tech world? As of now the target audience is confined to college circles, but then even Facebook used to be a college-only phenomenon once. Like Facebook, Fountainhop and Scoop too could one day expand to rope in millions of users from every walk of life. The thing is that smartphone usage is on the rise; in colleges almost every student worth his salt flaunts a smartphone, a few lucky ones even flash a latest iPhone or one of those Android powered devices. Applications like Foursquare, which provide location based networking mostly through smartphones, have already made a mark.

Fountainhop and Scoop must also be

seen in light of the fact that users these days are constantly looking for new ways by which they can share their ideas and build their networked groups. The campuses of larger universities have turned into a laboratory where new ideas and theories on networking can be experimented with before being released to rest of the society. If Fountainhop and Scoop are successful in attracting large number of users in the months to come, then they will become ripe for the next stage of their development.

Fountainhop

You can reach Fountainhop by pointing your browser to <http://www.fountainhop.com/public.php>. The main idea behind the



application is to let smartphone users in college be part of a closely networked community; everyone is seamlessly updated about campus events. The four co-founders of this application are Zavain Dar, Salik Syed, Stellios Leventis and Nikil Viswanathan. The short profiles that they have posted on the website make them seem like typical youngsters, but it is also clear that they are gearing to make a mark in highly competitive mobile apps space. So how did they come